

each DRAM chip will take up a smaller space on the production line.

Technology to aid differently abled

Many tools that could make a significant difference in the lives of the disabled were showcased at the Techshare India 2010 event organised recently in New Delhi.

Operating systems act as an interface between the computer and its users and hence play an important role in accessibility. Some of the operating systems nowadays, like Windows 7, come with options such as touch-screen monitor, on-screen keyboard (allows easy key-in using mouse or any other pointing device), narrator (reads aloud on-screen text and alerts during errors), speech recognition, visual notification, etc.

Software packages such as QualIWORLD provide users with the flexibility to use different software that could replace a physical mouse and keyboard. There are devices like Big Red that provide single-button access to the computer.

Screen readers that help the visually impaired work with computers are available from many companies. These read out what is being displayed on the screen. JAWS and NVDA are popular ones.

Web browsers such as Shruti Drishti provide text-to-speech and text-to-braille access for the visually impaired.

Classmate reader aids in learning by letting one listen to the audio version of textbooks while the text is highlighted on a large LCD screen.

Multilingual mobile keypad

Luna Ergonomics, a Noida-based start-up, has developed a multi-lingual keypad named Panini Keypad for millions of mobile users who do not know English. The keypad supports Hindi, Bengali, Telugu, Marathi, Tamil, Gujarati, Kannada, Malayalam, Oriya and Assamese, and can be downloaded

from the Web for free. It does not use printed characters of any language on the phone as the characters displayed on the screen can be typed using the numeric keypad.

The technology can also be adopted for PCs, Web, ATMs, touchscreen kiosks, etc. As of now, the software can be installed only on Nokia Java phones.

Talking pen

A publisher from Bhopal, Aadarsh, has launched a multimedia print reader (MPR) or talking pen that recites the written text. The technology has been developed to aid the learning experience of students by focusing on the enormous benefits of listening.

The MPR is an electronic device with an in-built camera, speakers, microphone for recording, 2GB flash memory, USB connectivity for downloading audio files and a lithium-ion battery. It works only with MPR-enabled books. When you take the head

The MPR-enabled books do not require any special ink for printing.

Earthquake-sensing robot

Students at J.T. Engineering College, Surat, have developed a robot that can detect an earthquake three hours in advance. The robot senses earthquake tremors with the help of two transmitters and one receiver.

The transmitters, buried inside the earth, sense the temperature, water and the water level before transitting the information through microwave frequencies. After receiving the information, the robot senses the vibration and gives off an alarm.

Indian IT firm to copy mammalian brain on computer

PIT Solution, a Kerala-based start-up, and Brain Mind Institute of Swiss Federal Institute, will be working on the Blue Brain Project—a \$3 billion initiative, which is the world's first



Multimedia print reader (MPR) from Aadarsh

of the pen closer to the MPR mark, the camera detects the code and plays the corresponding audio file.

You can segment the audio corresponding to a word, line, sentence or page and even for images. When you position the MPR over a book with MPR codes, it activates the pre-loaded audio files, so a reader is also able to hear the text being read.

comprehensive attempt to reverse-engineer the mammalian brain, reports mayukhi.com. The Kerala firm will attempt to build a computerised copy of a mammalian brain using one of the world's most powerful computers. The project would be monitored by a UN body for ethical treatment of animals, and is expected to be completed by 2018.

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